# SULCATA TORTOISE

Centrochelys sulcata

**Think About This**

If you carried your home on your back, what

**What can it see, hear, or feel?**

Its nose finds dry grass, its eyes spot movement, and it feels vibrations through the ground.

**Where does it live — and why?**

It lives in Africa's dry grasslands, digging deep burrows to escape the midday heat.

**How does it send messages?**

Males make a loud mating call, ram each other with their shells, and move to water after rain.

**What does it do when something changes?**

In peak heat it hides in its burrow; in very dry times it moves less to save energy.

**How does it learn?**

Young tortoises hatch alone and learn by trying which plants to eat in their new home.

**How does it have babies?**

A mother digs a nest and lays up to thirty eggs, which hatch about ninety days later.

**What are its limits?**

Cold is dangerous for it, and without burrows or shade, it can quickly overheat and die.

**What does this teach us?**

Slow body, dry diet, and deep burrows all work together as one survival system.